

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Claire O'Scuro

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12



Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Claire O'Scuro

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Your other secret

Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Dr. Art E. Fact has seen the same gap you found.
- Learn who wrote the anonymous warning note.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Claire O'Scuro

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*
- 2 *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*
- 3 *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant knew the provenance file had a hole in it. He wanted my name under a label pretending otherwise. I commissioned an independent review against the board's instructions. Its fee came out of an exhibition account. You may question my authority to spend it; you will not improve the title by suppressing the question.

IF MURDERER

Grant knew exactly what was missing from the provenance file. He threatened to remove me if I made it public. I commissioned an independent review and charged it to the exhibition. He was preparing to call that financial misconduct while presenting the bowl as immaculate. I had no intention of applauding either performance.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I checked the exposed cradle during installation, well before the mounting alert. Then I took the disputed file into the Registrar's vault. I wanted to compare the export papers without Grant leaning over my shoulder. When I came out, he had moved on to his toast and the exhibition label was still wrong.

IF MURDERER

I checked the cradle before the alert, then worked at the Registrar's outer desk. I made another pass by the gallery around 6:43. The curtain was down; I looked at the label copy on the desk instead. I was deciding which sentence I could defend when Grant called me insubordinate.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The file I carried into the vault had a white correction tab sticking out of the cover. I stayed inside until the custodian let me out at 6:45. I concealed the independent review behind the 1988 manifest. That was deliberate. An exhibition account should not pay for vanity, including a donor's.

IF MURDERER

I put the white correction tab in the provenance file at the outer desk and substituted a cautious label. The independent review is behind the 1988 manifest. I charged its fee to the exhibition without board consent. Grant wanted a clean public record; he was about to receive a substantially less flattering one.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS



Claire O'Scuro

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Claire O'Scuro

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I used exhibition money without authorization and hid the resulting report. The vault record and interior camera cover my whole stay while Grant's glass was exposed. My correction tab identifies the file I described. I could have ended the exhibition by publishing that report. I did not end his life.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The review was real. My shelter in the Registrar's Office was useful fiction: I stayed at the outer desk, then went to Grant's glass. I stole the reference toxin, used museum linen to coat the empty coupe and returned to the paperwork. I wanted my research to survive him. I made certain that it would.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.